

FOR THE LOVE OF SPORT

Siddhartha Nangia, the Co-founder of Smytten, likes to play badminton and believes sports is important to build character

BY **SMITA TRIPATHI**



PHOTO BY **NANDAN DAVE**

WHAT A RACQUET! Siddhartha Nangia loves playing all racquet sports but badminton is his first love

SIDDHARTHA NANGIA, Co-founder of Smytten—India's largest sampling-based e-commerce platform—remembers a lovely story from his childhood. On his tenth birthday whenever someone asked him what he wanted as a present he said he wanted a badminton racquet. "I ended up receiving seven badminton racquets as presents," smiles the 45-year-old.

Nangia has been passionate about sports, especially badminton, since he was a child. Today he plays all four racquet sports—badminton, tennis, table tennis and squash, but badminton remains his first love. He

plays regularly on weekends and at least twice during weekdays. "Sports is a great teacher and tells you a lot about a person's character," says Nangia adding that if he wasn't in the corporate sector, he would have been "doing something with sports". He admits that if a person's CV mentions that he likes to play sports then it piques his interest. "He/she is most likely to get at least an interview with me," he smiles. "Sports teaches you about your mistakes, your failures, how to get back on track, being a team player. I have not found a single sportsperson who is not a great team player," says Nangia.

Nangia plays at least two games of table tennis daily in office with colleagues before leaving for home. "Play-